



INSTITUTE OF ENVIRONMENTAL ENGINEERING

8/5 Podolskoye highway, Moscow, Russia, 115093

29th May, 2026.

**To the Admissions Committee
IHE Delft Institute for Water Education
Delft, The Netherlands**

Re: Letter of Recommendation for Stanley Chukwuebuka Okonkwo — Research MSc, Water Hazards, Risks and Climate

I am writing in support of Mr. Stanley Chukwuebuka Okonkwo, who has been a student in the MSc programme in Ecology and Nature Management at RUDN University since September 2024. I have taught him in courses including Economic Aspects of Natural Resource Management and Environmental Accounting and Reporting. He performed excellently across all of them.

What I noticed about Stanley in the classroom was that he connected the economic and governance dimensions of environmental problems to the technical ones more readily than most students do. In Natural Resource Management, while others tended to treat the economic analysis as a separate exercise from the ecological science, Stanley consistently asked how the two interacted; what the costs of inaction were, how you would structure incentives for restoration, who bore the risk when infrastructure failed. These are the right questions, and they pointed toward a student who was thinking about real policy problems rather than academic exercises.

His research focus on urban drainage failure and green infrastructure in Lagos is well suited to this kind of integrated thinking. Flooding in a city like Lagos is not simply a hydraulic engineering problem. It involves land tenure, municipal finance, governance capacity, and political will alongside the technical questions. The fact that Stanley's background covers geology, ecology, GIS analysis, and software development means he can engage with this problem from multiple angles simultaneously, which is what serious applied research on urban water systems requires.

I am also aware that he developed an ecological simulation tool called EcoSim during his studies, which models restoration scenarios for West African biomes. For a student to build a working research communication tool on his own initiative while completing a demanding postgraduate programme says something about his drive and his ability to manage complex, self-directed work.

IHE Delft is a strong fit for what Stanley wants to do next. The combination of water science, hydroinformatics, and a genuine focus on development contexts in the Global South aligns well with his research direction and his long-term goals for Nigeria.

Please feel free to contact me if you need any further information.

Yours Sincerely,

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